

COLORADO RARE BIRD REPORT

BLUE-WINGED WARBLER
Vermivora pinus

Red 2/2/01 upl

Location: "Goodnight" river trail along Arkansas R.; Pueblo; Pueblo, County, Colorado

Date: May 20, 2000

I believe Mark Yaeger found this bird; anyway I did not. I went to the location mentioned for this bird and almost immediately heard it singing. It was singing from a wet seep area with box elder, Russian olive, elm and lots of understory. The song was repeatedly given, a rising, buzzy "zee zee zee zeeeeee", yet it was an atypical song for this species to my ear. I found the bird in heavy foliage, at close range (about 25') and medium height (10-15') in the trees. I observed it with B & L Elite 10x42 binoculars. It was a clear, pleasant late morning. I watched it for about 20 minutes.

Description:

It was an adult, breeding-plumaged male. It foraged actively, sometimes tipping its body and probing leaflets and the ends of branches. This small, active warbler was about 5 1/2" long, with a relatively short dark tail, and a sharp, black pointed bill. The bird was overall bright, deep yellow with a grayish back, a greenish-gray crown and nape, and bluish-gray wings. The wings had two white wingbars. The bird had a black eyeline extending through the eye to the lores. The undertail coverts were white.

Similar Species:

The small size, active habits and small pointed bill indicate a wood warbler. Prothonotary Warbler is larger, bigger-billed; lacks the black eyeline and white wingbars. Orange-crowned, Tennessee and Yellow warblers lack the black eye-line and white wingbars. Most *Dendroica* sp. have streaked flanks. The Pine Warbler is not bright yellow and lacks the black eyeline. Oporornis and Wilsonia warblers lack wingbars.

Experience with Species:

I have seen the Blue-winged Warbler several times before in Colorado. I have seen numerous Blue-wingeds in the eastern U.S.

This report is prepared from notes made after observation.

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